



Create your own offline GPT-OSS

How to Install and Run on Windows PCs

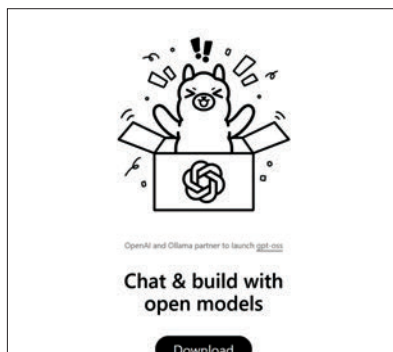
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GPT-OSS, OpenAI's open-weight language model series released in August 2025 under the Apache 2.0 license, empowers users to run advanced AI locally, ensuring privacy and control. Available in two variants – gpt-oss-20b (21 billion parameters, suitable for laptops with 16GB RAM) and gpt-oss-120b (117 billion parameters, requiring high-end GPUs like NVIDIA H100) – these models rival proprietary models like GPT-4o in reasoning, coding, and agentic tasks.

Before starting, ensure your Windows laptop meets the requirements for GPT-OSS. The gpt-oss-20b model, ideal for most laptops, needs at least 16GB of RAM (or unified memory with a GPU like NVIDIA 1060 4GB). The larger gpt-oss-120b requires ~80GB VRAM, making it impractical for typical

laptops. You'll also need Windows 10 (version 17763.0 or higher) or Windows 11 and a stable internet connection for downloading model weights. Ensure you have sufficient storage and, if available, a compatible GPU for faster performance.

You can download it using LM Studio, Hugging Face or Ollama. The easiest option is using Ollama.



Installing with Ollama

It is a user-friendly platform that simplifies downloading and running GPT-OSS models, with native support for the MXFP4 quantization format used by these models, optimizing them for consumer hardware.

1. **Download Ollama:** Visit Ollama's website and click the "Download" button for Windows. Run the installer and follow the on-screen instructions. This sets up the Ollama server, which runs in the background and starts automatically on system boot.
2. **Verify Installation:** Open a browser and navigate to <http://localhost:11434> to confirm the Ollama server is running. Alternatively, open a Command Prompt and type: `ollama --version`. You should see a version number (e.g., 0.1.44). If not, check the Ollama GitHub for troubleshooting.
3. **Download GPT-OSS Model:** Open the Ollama desktop app. In the dropdown menu, select "gpt-oss:20b." When you send a message, Ollama will automatically download the model (~13GB). Wait for the download to complete (progress is shown in the app).
4. **Run the Model:** In the Ollama app, select "gpt-oss:20b" and start chatting. Alternatively, in the Command Prompt, run: `ollama run gpt-oss:20b`. Type any prompt and press Enter. The response should appear almost instantly on a capable laptop.

Installing with LM Studio

LM Studio gives a graphical interface for GPT-OSS, ideal for users who prefer a ChatGPT-like experience with additional customization options.

1. **Download LM Studio:** Visit the LMStudio Website and download the Windows installer. Run it with default settings to install LM Studio. (version 0.3.21 or later)
2. **Download GPT-OSS Model:** Open LM Studio and go to the "Discover"